

Doubling up

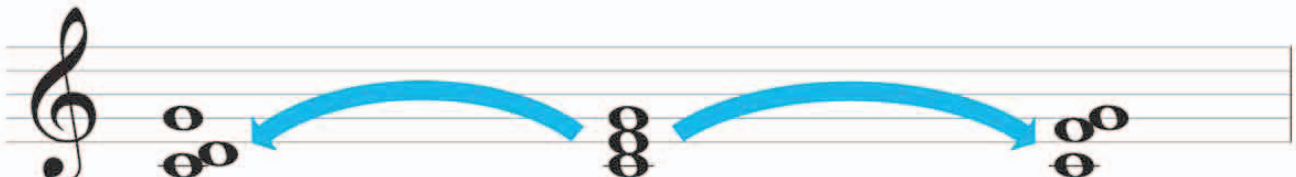
Chords with four notes are sometimes made by taking a simple triad and doubling one of its existing notes an octave higher or lower. Composers might choose to double the root, third, or fifth of a triad depending on the effect they want to create. Doubling the root, for example, emphasizes a chord's tonal center.

			
C major	A minor	E diminished	D augmented
△ Doubled root This C major triad has its root—C—doubled one octave higher.	△ Doubled third This A minor triad has its third—C—doubled one octave lower.	△ Doubled third This E diminished triad has its third—G—doubled one octave higher.	△ Doubled root This D augmented triad has its root—D—doubled one octave higher.

Suspended chords

Suspended chords are exceptions to the general rule that chords are triadic. The interval between the first two notes in a suspended chord is not a third, but a fourth (sus4) or, less often, a second (sus2). Suspended chords are so called because the second and fourth create dissonances, or suspensions, which then appear to require resolution back to the third.

- 104 ▽ **On the staff**
If the third of a C major triad (E) moves down to a second (D), the chord becomes Csus2. If the third moves up to a fourth (F), the chord becomes Csus4.



C sus2 **C major** **Csus4**

REAL WORLD

Michael Jackson

Suspended chords are commonly heard in pop music. A famous example is Michael Jackson's hit single "Black or White." The opening riff of the song features the chord sequence Esus4, E major, Esus2, E major. The fourths and seconds of the suspended chords can clearly be heard resolving onto the third of the major chord.



The **augmented triad** is often used as a **substitute** for the **dominant** in **pop songs** that are in a **major key**.